

# Meysam Alizadeh

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## CONTACT INFORMATION

Digital Democracy Lab  
Department of Political Science  
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## ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

### University of Oxford

Research Associate, Oxford Internet Institute, 2026 - Present

### University of Zurich

Senior Researcher, Digital Democracy Lab, 2021 - 2025

### Harvard University

Postdoc Fellow, Shorenstein Center on Media, Politics, and Public Policy, 2020 - 2021

### Princeton University

Postdoc Fellow, School of Public and International Affairs, 2018 - 2020, *Adviser: Jacob Shapiro*

### Indiana University Bloomington

Postdoc Fellow, Department of Informatics, 2016 - 2018, *Adviser: Santo Fortunato*

## EDUCATION

### George Mason University

Ph.D. in Computational Social Science, 2016

\* Committee: Claudio Cioffi-Revilla (Chair), Andrew Crooks, Naoru Koizumi

### University of Pittsburgh

M.Sc. in Information Science, 2012

### Amirkabir University of Technology

M.Sc. in Industrial Engineering, 2009

B.Sc. in Industrial Engineering, 2007

## RECENT PRE-PRINTS

Meysam Alizadeh, Fabrizio Gilardi, Mohsen Mosleh, Jacob Shapiro, Joshua Tucker (2026) "[Evaluating AI Coding Agents in Social Science Reproducibility](#)". To be Submitted to *Nature Machine Intelligence*.

Meysam Alizadeh, Helen Margetts, Jacob Shapiro, Mohsen Mosleh, Cosmina Dorobantu, Kevin Munger, Atoosa Kasirzadeh, Homa Hosseinmardi, Yian Yin, Rebekka Burkholz, Veronika Batzdorfer, Fabrizio Gilardi, Ingmar Weber, Joshua Tucker, & Michael Macy, (2026) "Towards Multi-Agent AI Co-Scientists for Social Science Research". Under Review at *Science*.

Meysam Alizadeh, Fabrizio Gilardi, Zeinab Samei & Mohsen Mosleh (2025) "[Web-Browsing LLMs Access Social Media Profiles and Infer User Demographics](#)". Submitted to *Big Data & Society*.

Meysam Alizadeh, Zeynab Samei, Daria Stetsenko & Fabrizio Gilardi (2025) "[Simple Prompt Injection Attacks Can Leak Personal Data Observed by LLM Agents During Task Execution](#)". Submitted to *ACM Conference on AI and Agentic Systems 2026*.

Meysam Alizadeh and Fabrizio Gilardi (2025) [“Data marketplaces increase willingness to sell social media data at low prices”](#). Under Review at *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*.

Meysam Alizadeh, Alicia Chen, Jacob Shapiro (2023) [“Russian Information Operations May Have Caused Hate Crimes”](#). OSF Preprints.

WORK IN  
PROGRESS

Meysam Alizadeh, Helen Margetts, Joshua Tucker, Atoosa Kasirzadeh, Mohsen Mosleh, & Homa Hosseinmardi “Examining the Trustworthiness of LLMs for Social Science Research Ideation”.

Meysam Alizadeh, Zeynab Samei, Joshua Tucker, Mohsen Mosleh, & Reza Arash “LLMs as Survey Respondents: Cross-Country Evaluation of Finetuning Approaches”.

Meysam Alizadeh & Mohsen Mosleh “Examining the effect of exposure to Polymarket content on spread and believability of misinformation”.

PEER-REVIEWED  
PUBLICATIONS

Meysam Alizadeh, Zeinab Samei, & Fabrizio Gilardi (2026) [“Unsupervised Elicitation of Moral Values from Language Models”](#). Forthcoming in Proceedings of *The International Association for Safe and Ethical AI (IASAI 2026)*.

Meysam Alizadeh, Mael Kubli, Zeinab Samei, Shirin Dehghani, Juan Diego Bermeo, Maria Korobeynikova, & Fabrizio Gilardi (2025) [“Open-Source LLMs for Text Annotation: A Practical Guide for Model Setting and Fine-Tuning”](#). *Journal of Computational Social Science*, 8(1), 1-25.

Nahema Marchal, Emma Hoes, K Jonathan Klüser, Felix Hamborg, Meysam Alizadeh, Mael Kubli, Christian Katzenbach (2025) [“How Negative Media Coverage Impacts Platform Governance: Evidence from Facebook, Twitter, and YouTube”](#). *Political Communication*, 42(2), 1-19.

Meysam Alizadeh, Darya Zare, Zeynab Samei, Mohammadamin Alizadeh, Mael Kubli, Mohammadhadi Aliahmadi, Sarvenaz Ebrahimi, Fabrizio Gilardi (2024) [“Comparing methods for creating a national random sample of twitter users”](#). *Social Network Analysis and Mining*, 14(160).

Shirin Dehghani, Mohammadmasiha Zahedivafa, Zahra Baghshahi, Darya Zare, Sara Yari, Zeynab Samei, Mohammadhadi Aliahmadi, Mahdis Abbasi, Sara Mirzamohajatabadi, Sarvenaz Ebrahimi, Meysam Alizadeh (2024) [“Leveraging Large Language Models for Fact-Checking Farsi News Headlines”](#). In Proceedings of the *Multidisciplinary International Symposium on Disinformation in Open Online Media (MISDOOM 2024)*, Lecture Notes in Computer Science, vol 15175. Springer, Münster, Germany, 01-04 September.

Meysam Alizadeh, Yasaman Asgari, Zeynab Samei, Sara Yari, Shirin Dehghani, Mael Kubli, Darya Zare, Juan Diego Bermeo, Veronika Batzdorfer, Fabrizio Gilardi (2024) [“Exploring Relationships Between Cryptocurrency News Outlets and Influencers’ Twitter Activity and Market Prices”](#). In Proceedings of the *The 16th International Conference on Advances in Social Networks Analysis and Mining (ASONAM 2024)*, Lecture Notes in Computer Science. Springer, Calabria, Italy, 02-05 September.

Fabrizio Gilardi, Meysam Alizadeh, Mael Kubli (2023) [“ChatGPT outperforms crowd-workers for text-annotation tasks”](#). *PNAS*, 120 (30), e2305016120.

Meysam Alizadeh, Emma Hoes, Fabrizio Gilardi (2023) [“Monetization of social media engagements increases the sharing of false \(and other\) news but penalization moderates it”](#). *Scientific Reports*, 13(1), 13703.

Meysam Alizadeh and Jacob Shapiro (2023) "[Few-Shot Information Operation Detection Using Active Learning Approach](#)". In Proceedings of the *16th International Conference on Social Computing, Behavioral-Cultural Modeling & Prediction and Behavior Representation in Modeling and Simulation (SBP-BRiMS)*, Pittsburgh, PA, USA, 20-22 September.

Meysam Alizadeh, Emma Hoes, Nahema Marchal, Mael Kubli, Jonathan Kaluser, and Fabrizio Giaraldi (2022) "[Content Moderation as a Political Issue: The Twitter Discourse Around Trump's Ban](#)", *Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media*, 2.

Veronika Batzdorfer, Holger Steinmetz, Marco Biella, Meysam Alizadeh (2022) "[Conspiracy theories on Twitter: emerging motifs and temporal dynamics during the COVID-19 pandemic](#)", *International journal of data science and analytics*, 13 , 315–333.

Meysam Alizadeh, Jacob Shapiro, Cody Buntain, and Joshua Tucker (2020) "[Content-based features predict social media influence operations](#)", *Science Advances*, 6 (3), eabb5824.

Meysam Alizadeh, Ingmar Weber, Claudio Cioffi-Revilla, Santo Fortunato, and Michael Macy (2019) "[Psychology and Morality of Political Extremists: Evidence from Twitter Language Analysis of Alt-Right and Antifa](#)", *EPJ Data Science*, 8:17.

Meysam Alizadeh, Claudio Cioffi-Revilla, and Andrew Crooks (2017) "[Generating Spatial Social Networks](#)", *Computational and Mathematical Organization Theory*, 23(3), 362-390.

Mohsen Gharakhani, Fatemeh Nasiri, and Maysam Alizadeh (2016) "[A Utility Theory Approach for Insurance Pricing](#)", *Accounting*, 2(4), 151–160.

Meysam Alizadeh and Claudio Cioffi-Revilla (2015) "[Activation Regimes in Opinion Dynamics: Analyzing Asynchronous Updating Schemes](#)". *Journal of Artificial Societies and Social Simulation*, 23 (1), 76–91.

Meysam Alizadeh, Claudio Cioffi-Revilla, and Andrew Crooks (2015) "[The Effect of In-Group Favoritism on the Collective Behavior of Individuals' Opinions](#)". *Advances in Complex Systems*, 18, 1550002.

Meysam Alizadeh, Alin Coman, Michael Lewis, and Claudio Cioffi-Revilla (2014) "[Intergroup Conflict Escalation Leads to more Extremism](#)". *Journal of Artificial Societies and Social Simulation*, 17 (4), 4.

Meysam Alizadeh and Claudio Cioffi-Revilla (2014) "[Distributions of Opinion and Extremist Radicalization: Insights from Agent-Based Modeling](#)". In Proceedings of the *6th International Conference on Social Informatics*, Barcelona, Spain, 10-13 November.

Meysam Alizadeh, Fariborz Jolai, Majid Aminnayeri, and Roy Rada (2012) "[Comparison of different input selection algorithms in neuro-fuzzy modeling](#)". *Expert Systems with Applications*, 39(1), 1536–1544.

Meysam Alizadeh, Roy Rada, Fariborz Jolai, and Elnaz Fotoohi (2011) "[An Adaptive Neuro-Fuzzy System for Stock Portfolio Analysis](#)". *International Journal of Intelligent Systems*, 26 (2), 99–114.

Meysam Alizadeh, Mohsen Gharakhani, Elnaz Fotoohi, and Roy Rada (2011) "[Design and Analysis of Experiment in ANFIS Modelling for Stock Price Prediction](#)". *International Journal of Industrial Engineering and Computation*, 2 (2), 409–418.

Meysam Alizadeh, Michael Lewis, M Hossein Fazel Zarandi, and Fariborz Joali (2011) “[Determining Significant Parameters in the Design of ANFIS](#)”. In Proceedings of the *0th North American Fuzzy Information Processing Society Annual Conference*, El Paso, TX, USA.

Meysam Alizadeh, Ehsan Safavieh, Elnaz Fotoohi, and Vahid Roshanaei (2009) “[Clustering based Fuzzy Particle Swarm Optimization](#)”. In Proceedings of the *28th North American Fuzzy Information Processing Society Annual Conference*, Cincinnati, OH, USA.

Meysam Alizadeh, Roy Rada, Akram Khaleghi, and Mir M. Seyed Esfahani (2009) “[Forecasting Exchange Rates: A Neuro-Fuzzy Approach](#)”. In Proceedings of the *International Fuzzy Systems Association World Congress*, Lisbon, Portugal.

BOOK  
CHAPTERS

M. Hossein Fazel Zarandi, Milad Avazbeigi, and Meysam Alizadeh (2012) “[A Neuro-Fuzzy Expert System Trained by Particle Swarm Optimization for Stock Price Prediction](#)”. In *Cross-Disciplinary Applications of Artificial Intelligence and Pattern Recognition: Advancing Technologies*, (Eds.) Vijay Kumar Mago and Nitin Bhatia. Information Science Reference, IGI Global.

Meysam Alizadeh (2009) “[Facility Location in Supply Chain](#)”. In *Facility Location: Concepts, Models, Algorithms and Case Studies*, (Eds.) Reza Zanjirani Farahani and Masoud Hekmatfar. Physica-Verlag Heidelberg, Springer.

CONFERENCE  
PRESENTATIONS  
(NON-ARCHIVAL)

Meysam Alizadeh (2023) “Data marketplaces increase willingness to sell social media data at low prices”. *119th American Political Science Association Annual Meeting & Exhibition (APSA 2025)*, Vancouver, BC, Canada, September 11 - September 14.

Meysam Alizadeh, Alicia Chen, Jacob Shapiro (2023) “Russian Information Operations May Have Caused Hate Crimes”. *119th American Political Science Association Annual Meeting & Exhibition (APSA 2023)*, Los Angeles, California, USA, August 31 - September 3.

Meysam Alizadeh, Darya Zare, Zeinab Samei, Mael Kubli, Sarvenaz Ebrahimi, Fabrizio Gilardi (2023) “Comparing Methods of Creating a Random Sample of Twitter Users from a Country”. *119th American Political Science Association Annual Meeting & Exhibition (APSA 2023)*, Los Angeles, California, USA, August 31 - September 3.

Meysam Alizadeh, Zeinab Samei, Mael Kubli, Fabrizio Gilardi (2023) “The Effectiveness of Framing on the Diffusion of Political Content”. *119th American Political Science Association Annual Meeting & Exhibition (APSA 2023)*, Los Angeles, California, USA, August 31 - September 3.

Meysam Alizadeh, Darya Zare, Mael Kubli, Sarvenaz Ebrahimi, Fabrizio Gilardi (2023) “Comparing Methods of Creating a Random Sample of Twitter Users from a Country”. *The 9th Annual International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2 2023)*, Copenhagen, Denmark, July 2023.

Meysam Alizadeh, Emma Hoes, Fabrizio Gilardi (2022) “Monetization of social media engagements increases the sharing of false (and other) news but penalization moderates it”. *118th American Political Science Association Annual Meeting & Exhibition (APSA 2022)*, Montreal, Canada, September 2022.

Meysam Alizadeh, Emma Hoes, Fabrizio Gilardi (2022) “Monetization of social media engagements increases the sharing of false (and other) news but penalization moderates it”. *12th European Political Science Association Annual Conference (EPSA 2022)*, Prague, Czech, June 2022.

Meysam Alizadeh, Jacob Shapiro, Cody Buntain, and Joshua Tucker (2019) “Identifying Foreign Influence Efforts’ Content on Social Media”. *European Symposium Series on Societal Challenges in Computational Social Science 2019: Polarization and Radicalization*, Zurich, Switzerland, September 2019.

Meysam Alizadeh, Ingmar Weber, Claudio Cioffi-Revilla, Santo Fortunato, and Michael Macy (2019) “Psychology and Morality of Political Extremists: Evidence from Twitter Language Analysis of Alt-Right and Antifa”. *European Symposium Series on Societal Challenges in Computational Social Science 2019: Polarization and Radicalization*, Zurich, Switzerland, September 2019.

Meysam Alizadeh, Jacob Shapiro, Cody Buntain, and Joshua Tucker (2019) “Identifying Foreign Influence Efforts’ Content on Social Media”. *2nd Annual Conference on Politics and Computational Social Science (PaCSS)*, Washington, DC, USA, August 2019.

Meysam Alizadeh, Santo Fortunato, Ingmar Weber, and Michael Macy (2018) “Social Contagion of Political Extremism”. *2018 International School and Conference on Network Science (NetSci 2018)*, Paris, France.

Meysam Alizadeh, Ingmar Weber, Claudio Cioffi-Revilla, Santo Fortunato, and Michael Macy (2017) “Psychological and personality profiles of political extremists”. *The 3rd Annual International Conference on Computational Social Science*, Cologne, Germany, 2017.

#### PATENT

Meysam Alizadeh and Jacob Shapiro (2022) “[System and method for machine learning based prediction of social media influence operations](#)”, *U.S. Patent Application No. 17/639,052*.

#### FELLOWSHIPS, AWARDS, AND RECOGNITIONS

Presidential Fellowship, Full Scholarship for Doctoral Studies, George Mason University, 2013-2016.  
Summer Research Fellowship, ONR-Minerva Grant No. N00014130054 (PI: Claudio Cioffi-Revilla), 2015 and 2016.

Full Graduate Research Scholarship, University of Pittsburgh, 2010-2012.

Full Scholarship, University of Maryland Baltimore County, 2009-2010.

#### TEACHING

##### *Instructor*

- Spring 2026: Digital Public Governance (PoliSci, University of Zurich)
- Spring 2010, Introduction to Data Analysis (ISchool, University of Maryland Baltimore County).

##### *Curriculum Design*

- 2022: Developed the full curriculum for M.A. and Ph.D. programs in Computational Social Science, Department of Computer Engineering, University of Tehran.

##### *Workshop*

- Spring 2022: Social Data Analysis, Institute for Research in Fundamental Sciences.
- Summer 2021: AI in Social Media Research, Department of Mathematics and Computer Science, Sharif University of Technology.
- Fall 2020: Introduction to Computational Social Science, Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering, University of Tehran.

##### *Teaching Assistant*

- Fall 2009: Department of Information Systems, University of Maryland Baltimore County.

*Member of dissertation and thesis committees:* Aida Mahmoudi (ICSS), Savana Diem (UZH), Hadi Aliahmadi (IUST), Mohammad Ghotbi (UT), Fatemeh Rajabi (AUT), Mahdi Davoudi (IRIBU), Ata Naghedifar (SUT), Masiha Zahedivafa (IUST).

*Dissertation, thesis, or project mentor:* Henrietta Toivanen (Princeton), Ali Ghazinejad (IU), Darya Zare (AUT), Alireza Mohammadian (SUT), Parsa Mirtaheri (SUT), Shirin Dehghani (ATU).

## INVITED TALKS

2025

- Workshop on The Future of Social Media Research (Oxford Internet Institute)

2024

- Transversal Research Priorities Areas Keynote Series (University of Zurich)
- Workshop on What Policies Can Promote Healthy AI? (Consensus Event, USA)

2023

- Workshop on Safeguarding Democracy from Online Disinformation, Digital Services Act Stakeholder Event (European Commission, Belgium)

2020

- Microsoft Seminar Series (Microsoft, WA)
- Center for Information Technology Policy Seminar Series (Princeton)

2019

- Center for Social Media and Politics (NYU)

## PROFESSIONAL SERVICE AND MEMBERSHIP

*Referee*

- Science Advances
- PNAS Nexus
- Web Conference
- International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM)
- AI & Society
- AI & Ethics
- Political Analysis
- Political Communication
- Journal of Computational Social Science
- EPJ Data Science
- Swiss Political Science Review
- PLOS ONE
- Scientific Reports
- Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media
- Scientific Data
- Social Networks Analysis and Mining
- Review of Economics and Statistics
- Computational and Mathematical Organization Theory
- Journal of Artificial Societies and Social Simulation
- Physica A: Statistical Mechanics and It's Applications
- Advances in Complex Systems
- Expert Systems with Applications
- Neural Computing and Applications
- Multidisciplinary International Symposium on Disinformation in Online Media (MISDOOM)
- Review of Policy Research
- Humanities and Social Sciences Communications

#### *Conference Program Committee*

- The ACM Web Conference, Research Track on Social Networks and Social Media, Dubai, UAE, April 13-17, 2026.
- Digital Democracy Workshop, Digital Society Initiative, University of Zurich, Zurich, Switzerland, October 28-29, 2021.

#### *Member*

- International Society for Computational Social Science (ISCSS)
- American Political Science Association (APSA)
- The Network Science Society
- The Network for Computational Modeling for SocioEcological Science (CoMSES)
- Peace Science Society

#### WRITINGS IN POPULAR MEDIA

Meysam Alizadeh, Cody Buntain, Jacob Shapiro, and Joshua Tucker, [“Are influence campaigns trolling your social media feeds?”](#), Published in The Monkey Cage / Washington Post, Oct 2020.

#### MENTIONS IN MEDIA OUTLETS

CryptoNews, [“AI Solutions Seek To Advance Real World Asset Tokenization”](#), May 9, 2024.

Yahoo! Finance, [“Tokenization News Roundup: Resource Extraction, Social Media Monetization and Real World Connections”](#), August 24, 2023.

France24, [“Twitter: all right under Elon Musk?”](#), May 25, 2023.

The Register, [“ChatGPT is coming for your jobs – the terrible ones, at least”](#), April 3, 2023.

New Scientist, [“ChatGPT outperforms humans at labelling some data for other AIs”](#), March 29, 2023.

VICE, [“ChatGPT Can Replace the Underpaid Workers Who Train AI, Researchers Say”](#), March 29, 2023.

BBC Digital Planet, [“Tracking the trolls”](#), July 29, 2020.

New Scientist, [“A weather forecast for fake news outbreaks on social media is coming”](#), July 29, 2020.

Bild Der Wissenschaft, [“KI-System erkennt Posts von Trollen und Bots”](#), July 27, 2020.

Deutschlandfunk Forschung Aktuell, [“Russland-Affäre: Algorithmus erkennt Trolle in staatlichem Auftrag”](#), July 23, 2020.

The Guardian, [“AI system detects posts by foreign ‘trolls’ on Facebook and Twitter”](#), July 22, 2020.

Newsweek, [“Chinese and Russian Trolls Trying to Influence 2020 Election Could Be Hunted with AI Tool”](#), July 22, 2020.

Inverse, [“Tracking Disinformation Using Digital Fingerprints”](#), July 22, 2020.

**Meysam Alizadeh**

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**References:**

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2- Dr Jacob Shapiro

Professor, Department of Political Science, Princeton University, USA  
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3- Dr Ingmar Weber

Professor in AI, Saarland University, Germany  
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5- Dr Atoosa Kasirzadeh

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